

Crew-12 Astronauts Splash Down After Long Mission

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Four **astronauts** from NASA's SpaceX Crew-12 mission came home after more than seven months on the **International Space Station**. Their spacecraft landed in the Pacific Ocean near Los Angeles on Thursday.

They spent 237 days in space, traveled more than 100 million miles, and circled Earth more than 3,792 times. The crew was Jessica Meir and Jack Hathaway from NASA, Sophie Adenot from Europe, and Andrey Fedyaev from Russia.

They landed at 8:34 a.m. Pacific time. Rescue teams picked them up by ship. They planned to go to NASA's Johnson Space Center in Houston.

On the station they did science for future Moon and Mars trips, including **stem-cell** studies and tests for making **IV fluids**. Meir also did four **spacewalks** on this mission.

Word Treasure

astronauts -- People trained to travel and work in space.

International Space Station -- A large orbiting lab where crews live and do science.

spacewalks -- Trips outside a spacecraft while wearing a spacesuit.

stem-cell -- About special cells that can grow into many other cell types.

IV fluids -- Liquid treatments given through a tube into a vein.

Background you need

Astronaut crews often stay on the International Space Station for months.

When a mission ends, a spacecraft can land in the ocean so ships can pick everyone up.

Station research helps prepare for longer trips farther from Earth.

Break it down

WHO: Jessica Meir, Jack Hathaway, Sophie Adenot, Andrey Fedyaev

WHAT: Crew-12 returned after 237 days on the space station

WHERE: Landing in the Pacific near Los Angeles

WHY: End of a long research mission supporting future exploration

Why it matters

Learning how crews come home safely helps kids see the teamwork behind space exploration.

Test what you remember

1. How many days did the crew spend in space?

- ☐ (A) 3,792 days
- ☐ (B) 10 days
- ☐ (C) 15 days
- ☐ (D) 237 days

2. Where did their spacecraft land?

- ☐ (A) A desert in Arizona
- ☐ (B) The Moon
- ☐ (C) Atlantic Ocean
- ☐ (D) Pacific Ocean near Los Angeles

3. Who did four spacewalks on this mission?

- ☐ (A) Andrey Fedyaev
- ☐ (B) Sophie Adenot
- ☐ (C) Jessica Meir
- ☐ (D) Jack Hathaway

4. About how many miles did they travel?

- ☐ (A) More than 100 million
- ☐ (B) About one thousand
- ☐ (C) Exactly 237
- ☐ (D) Twelve

5. Where were they heading after pickup?

- ☐ (A) The Moon base
- ☐ (B) NASA's Johnson Space Center in Houston
- ☐ (C) A school on Long Island
- ☐ (D) Virginia Tech

6. What kind of studies did they do on the station?

- ☐ (A) Only music lessons
- ☐ (B) Only baking classes
- ☐ (C) Only bike tests
- ☐ (D) Stem-cell studies and IV fluid tests

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: D 3: C 4: A 5: B 6: D

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):